

Welcome to the North Canterbury athletics presidents annual report 2019 /2020 season.

Once again, this season has been a very successful season for the club.

In the children's summer athletic section numbers were slightly down on previous years but the results still were very positive with medals won at the Colgate games and children selected for higher honours provincially, nationally and internationally. The club very much bats very high for its numbers registered. Under the dedicated guidance of Jo Ramsey as coach the children have reaped the rewards and have accomplished many personal bests for the season. It was great to have parents stepping up to help at trainings, special thanks to Nikora, Rodney and Paul. Also, to Mike for his help as manager on Saturday mornings.

This season there was six under 18 athletes competing in the afternoons, which is thrilling to see the juniors carrying on with athletics as a sport.

It is also pleasing to see athletes that were once registered with the club still competing on Saturdays and having athletics as a preferred sport.

The winter cross country and road race season had an increase of junior athletes competing in the children's age group. Top 10 places at the South Island champs Xanthe Jane 3rd, Harrison Bint 7th, Chelsea Reavill 5th and Zac Cowan 3rd.

The senior cross-country section has a small but very successful team. Often finishing on the podium as individuals or as a team rely. Congratulations to Jo and John who were selected for the Canterbury team for the National Cross-country champs in Wellington.

The Greta Valley relay has grown in strength with 30 entries this season. There was plenty of positive feedback with encouraging signs that people would like to return for another year. Thank you to John and Natasha for your tiresome work in running this event and those that helped on the day.

Already there is work going into organising the 2020 Greta event as well as the Andrew Reese relay in June which the club has put its hand up to host.

Thank you to all committee members for your work throughout the year. Without a great bunch of people, we would not accomplish so much as a small club. Ian, Mike, Marty, Annette, and John. Special mention to our wonderful bunch of parents who helped out in our fundraising, Saturday BBQ and chocolate sales.

Special mention to our outgoing Treasurer Natasha Mitchell. Thank you so much for your work with race day entries, subs and your spread sheets have been simple but so informative.

To our lady with her finger on the pulse Denise Pawsey our Secretary, although her daughter did not compete this year was still seen on Saturday mornings at the track whipping things into shape. Your pro-active stance on keeping parents informed is immeasurable for the club and its functioning.

Our ever thorn in our side has been the long jump run up. We started the season hoping to have the surface malfunction resolved but there have been many delays and lies and thanks to Ian and John who have kept the fight up to have a resolution.

For future growth the club is on the look out for another children's coach to help Jo.

Thank you for your support and may the 2020/2021 season be as prospective as the past seasons.

Alley Hendren

President North Canterbury Athletics.